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Submitter Information

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General Comment

Hello,

I am writing to encourage a focus on reducing energy consumption and increasing efficiency as a highest priority policy action that should be in the new AI Action Plan. AI data centers are highly resource intensive and are being built and operated at a time when our energy and water usage should be dropping sharply in order to give young Americans a livable future. In order to be worthy of the high resource usage, AI should only be used to solve our greatest problems, not be a ubiquitous and superfluous internet enhancer.

Data centers should mitigate the carbon emissions associated with AI's energy consumption by transitioning to renewable energy sources such as solar or wind and adopting energy-efficient practices. AI must have net zero emissions to keep pace with international climate goals. If AI does not comply with net-zero emissions, it will only serve to hasten and magnify human suffering rather than being the boon it purports to be.

Unless governments are using AI to redesign their power grid and its transmission, to inform mass reforestation efforts, and compelling the protection of the Colorado River, the current allocation of precious and irreplaceable resources to AI data centers negates its outputs.

Thank you for taking my comment,

KC Petersen